

1143

AFONSO I RECOGNIZED AS KING OF PORTUGAL

After defeating the Moors in a battle at Ourique in 1139, Afonso Henriques called himself “King of Portugal”, even though Portugal was, at the time, part of the Kingdom of Leon. Four years later, Alfonso VII of Castile recognized Afonso as king of Portugal.



▷ Afonso I statue

“This is an island resembling the head of an Ostrich, and contains flourishing cities, lofty mountains, flowing rivers and level ground.”

DESCRIPTION OF BRITAIN, FROM THE CHARTA, TEXT ACCOMPANYING THE TABULA ROGERIANA, 1154

1140

1145 Suryavarman II of Angor invades the Champa kingdom, sacking the capital, Vijaya

1148 The Second Crusade disintegrates into chaos after a failed siege of Damascus

1147 The Almohads invade Spain after Almoravid losses to the Christian states

1145

SECOND CRUSADE CALLED

When Imad al-Din Zengi, atabeg (governor) of Mosul, captured the crusader stronghold of Edessa, a second crusade was called by Pope Eugene III. Led by King Louis VII of France and German Emperor Conrad III, it set out for the Levant in 1147. A serious defeat at Dorylaeum depleted the crusader force and a botched attack on Damascus meant it achieved none of its objectives.



△ Louis VII embarks on crusade

1150

CITY OF CAHOKIA REACHES ITS HEIGHT

The principal settlement of the Mississippian Mound Building culture (known for their huge earthen ceremonial platforms), 12th-century Cahokia was home to 20,000 people. They engaged in the cultivation of maize, beans, and squash, and produced fine clay tobacco pipes and pottery. Their culture declined and collapsed in the 14th century, probably due to overexploitation of resources.



△ Nursing mother effigy, bottle from Cahokia